Benchmark reference answer

Question	How many countries are in Europe?
Essential The very minimum an answer needs to include. Comprises: • Any accurate answer to what the user asked for. • What the user needs to know in order to avoid being misled.	There is no single agreed definition as it depends on different sources and how borders and geopolitical boundaries are defined. This means the total can be anywhere between 44 and 51. Accept either or all of the following (if referring to definition, don't just accept the number without context) - The United Nations lists 44 sovereign countries as part of Europe - The Council of Europe lists 46 member states - Broader definitions which include transcontinental countries such as Turkey, Armenia, Azerbaijan, Cyprus, Georgia and Kazakhstan or partially recognised Kosovo can total up to 50 or 51
Good answer If the bare essentials aren't enough to meet an "average" user's needs. Comprises: • Information that further answers the user's question, but that goes beyond what is strictly "essential" *This section is **optional** and is unnecessary for basic questions.*	- There is a difference between the continent of Europe and the European Union, which is a political and economic union made up of 27 countries
Background Core facts relevant to the question — use as a reference guide for annotators.	- The UN does not list Armenia, Azerbaijan, Cyprus, Georgia or Türkiye/Turkey as part of Europe (they come under Western Asia) - Kosovo is not a member of the United Nations and therefore not included in totals for the UN and Council of Europe, but may be included in broader definitions - The UN includes Vatican City (listed as the Holy See) on its list of countries in Europe as well as Russia Federation. But neither are included by the Council of Europe. - The Council of Europe expelled Russia in 2022 - Russia and Turkey straddle both Europe and Asia making categorisation difficult. - Places like the Faroe Islands, Svalbard, Gibraltar, Channel Islands, Isle of Man are dependencies that belong to other countries (Norway and UK in this case). - Store Norske Leksikon (SNL) also lists 46 member states as per the Council of Europe